First News

11 Mar 2026

Employing Intelligent Investing — a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

Global, Regional Markets

Wall Street closed slightly lower following a highly volatile session dominated by shifting headlines regarding the conflict with Iran. While U.S. markets lagged, the Asian outlook remains cautiously optimistic as regional markets began to rebound from recent sharp sell-offs.
President Trump aims to calm the Iran conflict by waiving oil sanctions and using the U.S. Navy to escort tankers through the Strait of Hormuz. Despite ongoing regional warfare, he predicts a swift resolution to the crisis and a stabilization of global energy supplies.
UAE's Ruwais refinery halted after a drone strike fire; ADNOC cuts offshore output amid regional conflict. Coupled with Ras Tanura shutdown, Iranian threats to the Strait of Hormuz and Iraqi declines, oil prices have surged.
Confusion over US Navy escorts in the Strait of Hormuz rattled investors. After a deleted post from Energy Secretary Wright was contradicted by the White House, the S&P 500 dipped 0.2%, the Nasdaq stayed flat, and the VIX (fear gauge) hit 25.
Middle Eastern oil producers, including Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Iraq, and Kuwait, have reportedly reduced or considered cutting oil output by as much as 6.7M b/d due to severe regional disruptions.
Emerging-market stocks surged, led by South Korean and Taiwanese tech, as hopes for a US-Iran de-escalation eased tensions. Battered high-beta stocks are rallying and oil is falling in a classic risk-on reaction.
JPMorgan: Buy Japanese stocks on the dip. Recent selling over Iran-Israel tensions has left the market oversold. Strategist Rie Nishihara notes a 10–20% WTI oil spike would only trim earnings by 1–2%, as firms are now better at passing on costs.

Asia-Pacific

Index	3/10/2026	3/11/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	47,740	47,706	**-0.07%**
S&P 500	6,795	6,781	**-0.21%**
NASDAQ	22,695	22,697	**+0.01%**
PCOMP	6,006	6,006	**0.00%**
Nikkei (NKY)	52,728	54,248	**+2.88%**
Shanghai (SHCOMP)	4,096	4,123	**+0.66%**
Hang Seng (HSI)	25,408	25,959	**+2.17%**
KOSPI	5,251	5,532	**+5.35%**
SENSEX	77,566	78,205	**+0.82%**
TWSE	32,110	32,772	**+2.06%**
ASX 200	8,732	8,692	**-0.46%**
Bursa KLCI	1,674	1,701	**+1.61%**
JCI	7,337	7,440	**+1.40%**
STI	4,756	4,860	**+2.19%**
SET	918	932	**+1.53%**
VN-Index	1,652	1,676	**+1.45%**

Philippines

6,126 -120 pts, -2.01%

Range: 6,085 – 6,150

Breadth 147 (+) 58 (-) 64 (unch)

Block ₱1.10B **Volume** 1.39B

Value ₱7.49B

Share buyback: SMPH SM AGI OPM

52-wk High: ION OPM SPM

52-wk Low: ABG ALHI ALLHC BHI C FERRO MEDIC PRIM RCB ZHI

Overbought: None

Oversold: ATI DIZ GTCAP CHP TECH BPI SM ABG IS FERRO PHN COSCO LTG

Active	Value
ICT	710
BDO	123.80
BPI	103
ALI	19.22
AC	516
MBT	69
AP	42
SM	645
SMPH	19.60

Advancers	Decliners
PERC +12.94%	TCB2A -25.00%
ZHI +10.00%	FNI -15.46%
PXP +9.80%	EGRN -14.89%
OPM +8.33%	IMP -14.29%
FPI +8.00%	CEBCP -5.77%

Commodities — Metals & Agriculture

Commodity	3/10/2026	3/11/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude ($/bbl)	106.66	82.77	-22.40%
Brent Crude ($/bbl)	14.69	87.35	+494.62%
Gold — Comex ($/oz)	5,072	5,218	+2.88%
Silver — Comex ($/oz)	81.52	88.75	+8.87%
Platinum Spot ($/oz)	2,050	2,217	+8.15%
Copper — Comex (¢/lb)	564.8	593.0	+4.99%
Nickel ($/lb)	7.7597	7.8733	+1.46%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.5% ($/wmt)	74.00	80.00	+8.11%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.8% ($/wmt)	87.50	94.50	+8.00%
Coal ($/mt)	135.25	131.10	-3.07%
Corn (¢/bu)	460.5	453.0	-1.63%

Wheat (¢/bu)	616.75	590.0	**-4.34%**
Cocoa ($/mt)	3,230	3,447	**+6.72%**
Sugar (¢/lb)	14.10	14.38	**+1.99%**

Foreign Trade

NFB(S) $26.608 mn

Total FB Feb $107.960 mn

YTD NFB $322.78 mn

FB (₱) 3,515,671,716.53

FS (₱) 4,013,718,301.33

NFB(S) (₱) 498,046,584.80

TOTAL (₱) 7,529,390,017.86

Foreign Funds Bought

AUB EW SECB DHI SLF AP FGEN PCOR SCC SHLPH CNPF FCG RFM URC CIC ION AC RCR DITO CEB ICT MAC CEU STI SEVN AT

Foreign Funds Sold

BDO BPI CBC MBT PNB UBP PSE ACEN ALTER CREC FPH MER MWC MYNLD SGP DNL EMI FB GSMI JFC MONDE EEI AEV AGI COSCO DMC GTCAP JGS LTG SGI SM SMC ALI AREIT CREIT DD MEG MRC MREIT RLC SMPH GLO TEL CNVRG BLOOM PLUS WEB PGOLD RRHI APX FNI NIKL OGP PX

Smart Watch — Oversold

Financials & Holdings: BPI GTCAP LTG RCB

Conglomerates & Property: SM ALLHC ALHI COSCO

Industrial & Tech: ATI TECH CHP FERRO IS MINES DIZ

Others: ABG PHN PRIM ZHI

10yr Bond	3/10	3/11	%Chg
PHL	6.099	6.607	**+8.33%**
US	4.187	4.143	**-1.05%**

Currency	3/10	3/11	%Chg
USD-JPY	158.10	157.71	**+0.64%**
USD-PHP	59.488	58.916	**+0.06%**
USD-CNY	6.9092	6.8695	**+0.24%**
EUR-USD	1.1587	1.1639	**-0.35%**

PSE-Index Stocks

Stock	3/10/2026	3/11/2026	%Chg
AC	538.00	516.00	**-4.09%**
ACEN	2.55	2.49	**-2.35%**
AEV	32.80	30.80	**-6.10%**
ALI	20.20	19.22	**-4.85%**
AREIT	40.80	40.10	**-1.72%**

BDO	125.00	123.80	-0.96%
BPI	109.00	103.00	-5.50%
CBC	68.80	67.45	-1.96%
CNPF	36.00	34.00	-5.56%
CNVRG	13.82	13.70	-0.87%
DMC	9.60	9.50	-1.04%
EMI	15.34	15.32	-0.13%
GLO	1,660.00	1,602.00	-3.49%
GTCAP	588.00	566.00	-3.74%
ICT	718.00	710.00	-1.11%
JFC	199.70	195.20	-2.25%
JGS	26.20	26.00	-0.76%
LTG	15.24	14.40	-5.51%
MBT	71.50	69.00	-3.50%
MER	617.00	599.50	-2.84%
MONDE	6.29	6.00	-4.61%
PGOLD	37.95	37.60	-0.92%
PLUS	18.14	17.84	-1.65%
RCR	7.30	7.11	-2.60%
SCC	28.05	28.40	+1.25%
SM	680.00	645.00	-5.15%
SMC	71.95	69.75	-3.06%
SMFB (FB)	51.60	52.70	+2.13%
SMPH	20.80	19.60	-5.77%
TEL	1,355.00	1,315.00	-2.95%
URC	71.70	69.50	-3.07%

JFC 195.20 / 90

- FY25 net income up 5.4% to ₱10.9B; FY EPS +6.0% at ₱9.386.
- JFC projects full-year system-wide sales growth of 8–12%, with same-store sales growth of 4–6% and store network increase of 5–10%. Operating income growth will be 15–18%.
- Jollibee reports record 4Q system-wide sales reaching ₱122.3B. Finalizes agreement to acquire Korean Hot Pot Chain for $87M. Plans to list global subsidiary. Highlands Coffee's goal to finalize IPO by Q1 2027.
- JFC plans to expand network by 1,200–1,300 stores (gross) in 2026 with capex of ₱13.0–16.0B.

Recommendation: Positive / BUY. Record Q4 OI of ₱4.14B (+41.9% YoY) — the highest in JFC history. Strong 2026 guidance and expanding international pipeline. Accumulate at ₱195–200.

FB (SMFB) 52.70 +2.33%

- FY2025 Net Income +13% to ₱46.3B on Food, Spirits, International Beer.
- Consolidated revenues rose 4.5% to ₱419.1B. Operating income grew 9.3% to ₱61.0B and EBITDA expanded 10% to ₱80.6B, improving EBITDA margin to 19%.

- Net income attributable to equity holders of the parent jumped 17%. Food segment delivered record operating income; spirits (Ginebra San Miguel) revenues grew 8% to ₱67.4B; international beer sales expanded.

Recommendation: Positive. Double-digit profit growth across all key segments. BUY SMC/SMFB on any macro-driven weakness.

DHI 4.10 +11.72%

- Monte Sur is 60% owned by Ashdale Holdings, Inc. & 40% by Freefort Investments Limited (BVI), with directors linked to the Sy group. DHI is expected to transition into a mining holding co., with speculation focusing on its role in the massive Tampakan project.

FEU 800

- Acquires 60.34% stake in Bataan college (University of Nueva Caceres–Bataan); enrollment near 60,000, highest since pre-pandemic.

FGEN 17.50

- Scaled back Prime Infra hydro stake to 33% at ₱61.9B — prudent capital management. Projects: 1,400-MW Pakil (Laguna) + 600-MW Wawa (Rizal) pumped storage.

MER 599.50 / 600

- Buy on weakness. Nuclear MOU with Korea's KHNP/KEXIM; targeting first Philippine nuclear kWh by 2032. ERC rate reset ruling expected June–July 2026 (₱2.34/kWh petition).

CNVRG 13.70

- Buy on Weakness. 2025 net income +9.6% to ₱11.9B; 60%+ EBITDA margins; enterprise revenue growing 20% +. Selloff is macro-driven, not fundamental.

BPI 103.00
AP 42.00
AEV 30.80

BPI Extends ₱6.1B Project Finance Loan for AboitizPower's First Wind Farm

- Bank of the Philippine Islands (BPI) has approved a ₱6.1B project finance facility to Cornerstone Energy Development, Inc. (CEDI), a subsidiary of Aboitiz Renewables Inc. under AboitizPower. The loan will fund the 58.5-MW Camarines Sur Wind Power Project in Libmanan — AboitizPower's first wind energy venture. Construction began in 2025.
- BPI 2025 net income rose 7.4% YoY to ₱66.62B. BPI shares closed at ₱103 (+1.38%) on Tuesday. The transaction reinforces BPI's sustainable finance leadership in the Philippines.

Recommendation: Positive for both names. For AboitizPower (AP), adding wind to its RE portfolio (geothermal, hydro, solar, BESS) diversifies generation mix. For BPI, green project finance builds a differentiated ESG loan book. Both are ACCUMULATE names.

MYNLD 19.70

Maynilad Nears Completion of ₱10.5B CAMANA Wastewater Facility

- West Zone concessionaire Maynilad Water Services is in the final stages of completing the CAMANA (Caloocan-Malabon-Navotas) Water Reclamation Facility — its largest wastewater treatment plant, valued at ₱10.5B. The facility in Maypajo, Caloocan City will treat up to 205 million liters of wastewater daily, serving approximately 1.2 million customers in South Caloocan, Malabon, and Navotas.
- Completion is later than originally targeted (2025 deadline). Maynilad is also completing upgrades to La Mesa Treatment Plants 1 and 2 (₱7.9B project) and new pipeline segments in Las Piñas. Maynilad 2025 net income rose 19% to ₱15.2B.

Recommendation: Positive / Monitor. Infrastructure milestones support the long-term investment thesis. Completion overhang now largely resolved. Watch for MWSS concession rate reset updates as the next earnings catalyst.

DD 9.30

Hotel101 Opens 680-Room Madrid Hotel — First Filipino Brand Overseas

- Hotel101 Global Holdings Corp. (NASDAQ: HBNB), the hospitality subsidiary of Philippine-listed DoubleDragon Corp. (DD), officially opened Hotel101-Madrid on March 10, 2026 — the first Filipino homegrown hotel brand to operate overseas. The 680-room property in Madrid's Valdebebas district ranks among the top 5 largest hotels in Spain by room count.

- Located adjacent to Real Madrid's Ciudad Real Madrid training complex, near IFEMA convention centre, and seven minutes from Madrid-Barajas International Airport. Features: HappyRoom units with kitchenettes, pools, function rooms, gym, restaurant, and 200+ parking spaces.
- Pipeline: Hotel101-Niseko (Hokkaido, December 2026), Hotel101-Melbourne (766 rooms), Hotel101-Milan. HBNB market cap approximately US$1.9B as of March 9, 2026.

Recommendation: Positive / Mildly Bullish for DD. Hotel101-Madrid transitions the platform from pre-development into recurring European revenue. Watch occupancy metrics and RevPAR as key early indicators of scalability outside the Philippines.

FLI 0.77

Plans ₱11.57B Bond Issuance — Third Tranche Under ₱35B Shelf Program

- Filinvest Land, Inc. (FLI) disclosed board approval to issue up to ₱11.57B in fixed-rate peso bonds, the third tranche under its ₱35B SEC shelf registration. Maturities of up to 10 years. Proceeds will refinance existing debt and fund capex across residential, commercial, and industrial segments.

Recommendation: Neutral to Mildly Positive. Refinancing existing debt at potentially lower long-term rates is prudent capital management. No immediate earnings catalyst; medium-term positive for balance sheet.

ENERGY

GCG Orders Closure of PNOC Renewable Energy Unit

- The Governance Commission for GOCCs (GCG) has ordered the closure of PNOC Renewables Corporation (PNOC-RC), the renewable energy subsidiary of state-owned Philippine National Oil Company organized in 2008. The GCG cited the unit as non-performing or redundant given the current private-sector RE landscape. Follows GCG's mandate under RA 10149 to evaluate GOCC relevance and efficiency.
- This does not affect PNOC's core oil, gas, and coal operations, nor its listed subsidiaries. The RE pipeline previously under PNOC-RC may be redirected to PNOC itself or to private sector partners.

Recommendation: Policy/Sector Neutral. The closure signals government streamlining of state-owned RE entities, not a policy retreat from renewables. Private RE developers (ACEN, EDC, FGEN, AP) are unaffected and may benefit from reduced state competition.

BRN 0.93
ALTER 0.75

Philippine Competition Commission Clears A Brown–Alternergy Wind Joint Venture

- The PCC has cleared A Brown Company, Inc.'s proposed investment in Alternergy Wind One Corp., the wind energy subsidiary of Alternergy Holdings Corp. The ruling authorizes A Brown to acquire a stake in the wind project entity, enabling joint development of wind power assets. The clearance removes regulatory risk for the transaction.

Recommendation: Positive for ALTERNERGY (ALTER). PCC clearance is a key milestone; the A Brown partnership diversifies funding for Alternergy's wind pipeline. MONITOR / ACCUMULATE ALTER on dips.

SEC Eases Rules for Early Stockholders' Meetings

- The SEC announced a relaxation of rules governing the scheduling of annual stockholders' meetings (ASMs), allowing listed companies greater flexibility to hold ASMs earlier in the calendar year. The change reduces administrative friction for companies with earlier fiscal year-end reporting cycles.

Recommendation: Broadly Positive / Governance. Streamlines corporate governance processes for PSE-listed companies. No direct earnings impact but improves market efficiency and issuer flexibility.

FNI 1.88

Ipilan Nickel Cites Valid Permits After Senate Hearing Allegations

- Ipilan Nickel Corporation issued a statement citing the validity of its government-issued permits and environmental compliance certificates following claims raised at a Philippine Senate hearing. The company maintained that its Environmental Compliance Certificate (ECC) and Mineral Production Sharing Agreement (MPSA) are in order and that operations comply with applicable regulations.
- Ipilan's Palawan nickel operations have been a flashpoint for environmental and indigenous peoples' rights concerns. The Senate hearing scrutinized permit issuances and operational compliance.

Recommendation: Watch / Neutral. Regulatory and reputational risk remains elevated until Senate proceedings conclude. Investors in NIKL or upstream nickel names should monitor hearing outcomes closely before adding exposure.

PHN 14.30

PHINMA Hospitality Breaks Ground on TRYP by Wyndham Bacolod

- PHINMA Hospitality broke ground on TRYP by Wyndham Bacolod — a 150-room lifestyle hotel within the Saludad township development in Bacolod City, Negros Occidental. Design reflects the city's MassKara Festival heritage, sugar industry roots, and culinary culture (deep violet tones, sugarcane textures, caramelized sugar-inspired lighting).
- Saludad is a ₱12B mixed-use township combining the TRYP hotel, a Southwestern University PHINMA campus, and construction materials group. PHINMA chair Ramon del Rosario cited Bacolod's strong growth prospects as key drivers.

Recommendation: Mildly Positive for PHN. Provincial tourism and integrated township strategy adds long-term asset value. Monitor Saludad Phase 1 completion (Q1 2026 target) and occupancy ramp.

ACR 0.61

Alsons Sells Remaining Stake in Seafront Resources

- Alsons Consolidated Resources (ACR) of the Alcantara Group has divested its remaining equity stake in Seafront Resources Corporation (SPM). This follows Seafront's recently completed share buyback program, under which SPM acquired up to 34.58M shares (21.21% of total outstanding) at ₱2.70 per share via a tender offer from January 29 to February 27, 2026, with settlement on March 12, 2026.
- The divestiture allows ACR to focus capital on its core power generation and renewable energy businesses in Mindanao. ACR operates 468 MW of generation capacity across four facilities, serving 14 cities and 11 provinces.

Recommendation: Neutral for ACR; mildly positive for portfolio focus. Divestiture recycles capital toward ACR's strategic RE expansion. SPM stake sale is not a material earnings event. Watch ACR's upcoming RE project completions (hydro, solar, Mindanao wind) as the medium-term catalyst.

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